



Spell Check

The degeneration of our language was a slow, insidious process that just happened as a natural consequence of technology. Tools like spell check are what run our lives as we go about our daily chores, oblivious to our excessive dependence on such tech. Gaming is also seeing a degeneration of sorts. It's time for a wake-up call; a reality check.

Reality CHECK

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Games are works of art and it takes a true artist to create a truly great game. Art is meant to inspire emotion, provide a unique experience, engender an opinion and entertain. Games do manage to accomplish all of the above, but somewhere along the line something goes wrong and we're left with a train-wreck of a game that is not worth playing, or worse still, a game that is of no significance, something that is just lost in the crowd and no one remembers.

A game can be technically sound but it can still fail, much like how a badly composed, but crystal clear photograph is still nothing more than a bad photograph. Why are the games of today unable to live up to their peers? Is the art of intelligent game design dying out? We believe it is.

Who is the real gamer?

It takes a real gourmet to appreciate something such as a well-made *Pizza ai Quattro*

Formaggi. Someone who's not into food will just accept it as another pizza, while the wannabe connoisseur will go into raptures and wax lyrical over the merits of aged cheddar vs. Roquefort cheese. The true connoisseur will just eat, appreciate and enjoy the exquisite concoction placed before him and revel in the flavour.

That is the real gamer. A person who can appreciate the finer aspects of a game, understand what went into the creation of that unforgettable experience and really



Just another cheese pizza or a masterpiece of the culinary arts?

play the game the way it was meant to be played. Arcade games like Pong and Pac Man are timeless classics but they're a different breed of games. If they were food they would be chocolate; something that everyone likes for its simplicity and flavour. It's a no-brainer. People will eat chocolate and it's very difficult to get it wrong. Such arcade games will always exist; they will always be a part of our "diet" and will evolve to support almost every gaming platform that can exist because of their simplicity, accessibility and as a consequence of this, sheer portability. But, these games can never be the main course. They can be the desert, the aperitifs, but there isn't enough meat on them to satisfy that real hunger that plagues real gamers.

A real gamer is one who will not just dismiss the Call of Duty franchise as a bad game but appreciate it for its well-implemented multiplayer; one who won't just dismiss Assassin's Creed as